VENVLEARNING

STUDENT WORKBOOK



Social Studies

GRADE 7

Daily practice, weekly checks, and unit tests

2026–2027 School Year · Unit 1: Early Humans and Mesopotamia

VENVLEARNING

Grade 7 Social Studies

STUDENT WORKBOOK

2026–2027 School Year

Unit 1 Early Humans and Mesopotamia

This book belongs to _____

A VenvLearning family homeschool curriculum

How to use this workbook

Every lesson in your textbook has matching practice pages here. Show your thinking in the work space. When a problem has an answer line, write your final answer there.

- Warm-Up reviews something you already know.
- Practice uses today's lesson.
- Think Deeper problems ask you to explain or find a mistake.
- Exit Ticket shows your teacher what you learned today.

Contents

Early Humans and Mesopotamia 3

Lesson 1.1: How Historians Know the Past 4

Lesson 1.2: Early Humans: Hunter-Gatherers 6

Weekly Check 1: Historians and Early Humans 7

Lesson 1.3: The Agricultural Revolution 8

Lesson 1.4: From Villages to Civilizations 9

Weekly Check 2: Farming and Civilization 10

Lesson 1.5: Mesopotamia: The Land Between the Rivers 11

Lesson 1.6: Sumer: City-States, Ziggurats, and Society 13

Weekly Check 3: Mesopotamia and Sumer 14

Lesson 1.7: Cuneiform and the Invention of Writing 15

Lesson 1.8: Empires and the Code of Hammurabi 16

Unit 1 Review 18

Unit 1 Test 19

UNIT 1

Early Humans and Mesopotamia

Historians' tools, early humans, the Agricultural Revolution, the first cities, Sumer, writing, and the first empires and laws.

Your practice pages for Unit 1. Each lesson matches the same lesson number in your textbook.

UNIT VOCABULARY

primary source	Created at the time by a participant.
Agricultural Revolution	The shift to farming.
civilization	A complex society with cities and government.
irrigation	Bringing water to crops.
cuneiform	Sumerian wedge-shaped writing.
empire	Many lands under one ruler.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.1 · PRACTICE

Lesson 1.1: How Historians Know the Past

Name _____ Date _____

I can distinguish primary and secondary sources, explain how archaeologists learn about the past, and read a BCE/CE timeline.

Warm-Up

1. An object made by people long ago

2. A source made by an eyewitness

Practice

3. Primary or secondary: a diary from 1863

4. Primary or secondary: your history textbook

5. Primary or secondary: a stone tool

6. Order from earliest: 1200 BCE, 3500 BCE, 200 CE, 500 BCE

7. Years from 3000 BCE to 1000 BCE

8. Years from 200 BCE to 300 CE

9. A king's victory monument says he never lost a battle. Why should a historian be careful with this source?

Exit Ticket

10 Name one strength and one limit of using artifacts as evidence.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.2 · PRACTICE

Lesson 1.2: Early Humans: Hunter-Gatherers

Name _____ Date _____

I can describe how early humans lived as hunter-gatherers and spread across the world.

Warm-Up

1 Old Stone Age

2 A person who moves from place to place

Practice

3 Why did groups stay small?

4 What do cave paintings suggest about early people?

5 How did fire change life?

6 Explain why archaeologists know more about Paleolithic tools than Paleolithic clothing.

Exit Ticket

7 Describe one advantage and one challenge of the hunter-gatherer way of life.

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri Oct 16 · ABOUT 15 MINUTES

Weekly Check 1: Historians and Early Humans

Name _____ Date _____

Show what you know

1. Primary or secondary: a photo taken in 1920

2. Primary or secondary: an encyclopedia article

3. Which is earlier: 1500 BCE or 900 BCE?

4. Years between 300 BCE and 200 CE

5. Where did Homo sapiens first appear?

6. Why did hunter-gatherers move from place to place?

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.3 · PRACTICE

Lesson 1.3: The Agricultural Revolution

Name _____ Date _____

I can explain how farming began and how it changed human life.

Warm-Up

1. New Stone Age

2. Taming plants and animals

Practice

3. Two crops first domesticated in the Fertile Crescent

4. A crop first domesticated in Mexico

5. Why did farming lead to settled villages?

6. How did surplus lead to new jobs?

7. Write a claim: Was the Agricultural Revolution good for humans? Support it with two pieces of evidence.

Exit Ticket

8. Why do historians call farming a “revolution” even though it took thousands of years?

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.4 · PRACTICE

Lesson 1.4: From Villages to Civilizations

Name _____ Date _____

I can identify the features of a civilization and explain how surplus led to cities.

Warm-Up

1 A complex society with cities and writing

2 Doing one kind of job

Practice

3 Why might a growing town need a government?

4 Why did record keeping develop?

5 Put in order: cities, surplus, farming, specialization

6 Is your community a civilization by the historians' definition? Use three features as evidence.

Exit Ticket

7 Explain the chain from farming to cities.

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri Oct 23 · ABOUT 15 MINUTES

Weekly Check 2: Farming and Civilization

Name _____ Date _____

Show what you know

1. Where did farming first begin?

2. What is a food surplus?

3. Name two features of a civilization.

4. Name an early farming town.

5. Explain how a food surplus led to specialized jobs.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.5 · PRACTICE

Lesson 1.5: Mesopotamia: The Land Between the Rivers

Name _____ Date _____

I can explain how the geography of Mesopotamia shaped early civilization there.

Warm-Up

1 Rich soil left by floods

2 Bringing water to crops

Map and Analyze

3 Use the map. Which body of water do the Tigris and Euphrates flow into?

The Fertile Crescent



4 In which modern country is most of Mesopotamia?

5 Which city on the map is farthest south?

6 Explain how a geographic challenge led to cooperation and government.

Exit Ticket

7 Were the rivers more helpful or harmful to Mesopotamians? Explain.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.6 · PRACTICE

Lesson 1.6: Sumer: City-States, Ziggurats, and Society

Name _____ Date _____

I can describe Sumerian city-states, religion, and social classes.

Warm-Up

1. Belief in many gods

2. A city with its own government

Practice

3. Who was at the top of Sumerian society?

4. Name one right Sumerian women had.

5. Why were scribes respected?

6. What does the location and size of the ziggurat suggest about the role of religion in Sumer?

Exit Ticket

7. Compare a Sumerian city-state with a modern U.S. city.

WEEKLY CHECK · Fri Oct 30 · ABOUT 15 MINUTES

Weekly Check 3: Mesopotamia and Sumer

Name _____ Date _____

Show what you know

1. The two rivers of Mesopotamia

2. Bringing water to crops through canals

3. A stepped temple tower

4. Belief in many gods

5. Describe one geographic challenge in Mesopotamia and how people solved it.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.7 · PRACTICE

Lesson 1.7: Cuneiform and the Invention of Writing

Name _____ Date _____

I can explain how and why writing developed in Sumer and how it changed society.

Warm-Up

1. Tool used to write on clay

2. A long poem about a hero

Practice

3. About when did writing begin in Sumer?

4. Why did scribes train for years?

5. Name a Sumerian idea we still use.

6. Explain how writing helped governments become more powerful.

Exit Ticket

7. Which Sumerian invention do you think was most important? Defend your choice.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 1.8 · PRACTICE

Lesson 1.8: Empires and the Code of Hammurabi

Name _____ Date _____

I can describe the first empires and analyze Hammurabi's Code as a primary source.

Warm-Up

1 Many lands ruled by one government

2 A tall carved stone slab

Analyze the Source

PRIMARY SOURCE

From the Code of Hammurabi

Babylon, about 1754 BCE. Translated by L. W. King (1910). Public domain.

196. If a man put out the eye of another man, his eye shall be put out.

198. If he put out the eye of a freed man, or break the bone of a freed man, he shall pay one gold mina.

199. If he put out the eye of a man's slave, or break the bone of a man's slave, he shall pay one-half of its value.

229. If a builder build a house for some one, and does not construct it properly, and the house which he built fall in and kill its owner, then that builder shall be put to death.

3 What happens to a builder whose house collapses and kills the owner?

4 What is the punishment for putting out a freed man's eye?

5 Why would Hammurabi carve his laws in stone in a public place?

6 Name one way the code is like modern law and one way it is different.

Exit Ticket

7 Why was writing laws down an important step for civilization?

UNIT REVIEW · Thu Nov 5 (homework) or as needed · ABOUT 40 MINUTES

Unit 1 Review

Name _____ Date _____

Vocabulary

1. artifact

2. domestication

3. city-state

4. cuneiform

5. empire

6. surplus

Big ideas

7. Explain how geography, farming, and writing each helped Sumer become a civilization.

UNIT TEST · Fri Nov 6 · ABOUT 45 MINUTES

Unit 1 Test

Name _____ Date _____

Show your work. This test has 20 points.

Part A · Historians' tools (1 point each)

1. Primary or secondary: a clay tablet from Ur

2. Primary or secondary: a documentary about Sumer

3. Order from earliest: 1754 BCE, 3200 BCE, 2334 BCE

4. How many years from 2000 BCE to 1500 BCE?

Part B · Early humans and farming (1 point each)

5. How did most Paleolithic people get food?

   A farming
   B trading in cities
   C hunting and gathering
   D fishing fleets

6. What is domestication?

7. Name one benefit and one problem of farming.

8. Which came first?

   A cities
   B food surplus
   C writing

Part C · Mesopotamia (1 point each)

9 Use the map. Which labeled city is farthest south, closest to the Persian Gulf?



10 Why did Mesopotamians need irrigation?

11 What was a ziggurat?

12 What was cuneiform first used for?

13 Who created the first empire?

Part D · Primary source (3 points)

PRIMARY SOURCE

From the Code of Hammurabi

Babylon, about 1754 BCE. Translated by L. W. King (1910). Public domain.

196. If a man put out the eye of another man, his eye shall be put out.

198. If he put out the eye of a freed man, or break the bone of a freed man, he shall pay one gold mina.

199. If he put out the eye of a man's slave, or break the bone of a man's slave, he shall pay one-half of its value.

229. If a builder build a house for some one, and does not construct it properly, and the house which he built fall in and kill its owner, then that builder shall be put to death.

14 Reread the excerpt from Hammurabi's Code. What does it show about justice and social class in Babylon? Use two laws as evidence.

Part E · Explain (4 points)

15 Explain how the geography of Mesopotamia led to the development of government and laws.

Grade 7 Social Studies

Student Workbook · 2026–2027

A full year of Grade 7 social studies. Students read maps, weigh primary and secondary sources, build timelines, and connect geography, history, government, and economics to the people and places that shaped our world.

This Student Workbook holds the daily practice pages for every lesson, plus each Friday's Weekly Check, the unit reviews, and the unit tests, with room to show thinking and write complete answers.

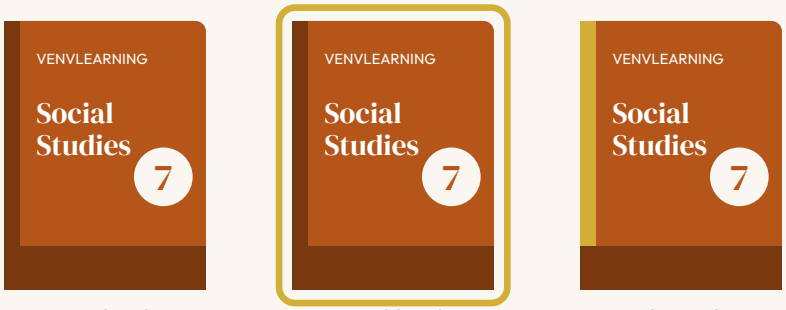
INSIDE THIS YEAR

01 Early Humans and Mesopotamia

IN THIS BOOK

- Warm-ups, practice, and exit tickets for every lesson
- Weekly Checks every Friday
- Unit reviews and unit tests
- Space to show work and explain thinking

THE COMPLETE SET



Textbook

Workbook

You are holding this book

Teacher Edition

Each lesson has the same number in all three books, and every day of the year is mapped to its lesson in the VenvLearning planner.